

Francis Alwyn Coomans

Founder & Lead Consultant | Enterprise IT, Networks & Security

OSCP, CPTS, CWES | 25+ Years in IT & Security

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Location: Gauteng, South Africa

Professional Summary

Founder & Lead Consultant with **25+ years of experience** designing and delivering enterprise IT, networking, and security solutions.

I lead the **architecture, security, and delivery of resilient IT environments**, combining decades of hands-on infrastructure and systems experience with advanced cybersecurity expertise. My background includes enterprise **Active Directory, Microsoft 365, networking, virtualisation, endpoint security, audits, compliance, and large-scale IT project delivery**.

I hold advanced security certifications including **OSCP, CPTS, and CWES**. This offensive security expertise directly informs how I design and secure real-world IT environments — enabling me to understand not only how systems should be built, but how they are attacked and where genuine risk exists.

Through Netrunnerz (Pty) Ltd, I provide **end-to-end accountability for IT and security initiatives**, working directly with clients and trusted specialist partners to deliver scalable, secure, and practical solutions aligned to business objectives.

Key Achievements

- Earned **Bachelor of Commerce in Business Informatics (Cum Laude)** while working full-time.
 - Ranked **Top 1% globally** on Hack The Box (“Pro Hacker”) and HTB Academy.
 - Completed **OSCP, CPTS, and CWES** through intensive hands-on labs and examinations.
 - Completed **50+ complex Active Directory, network, and web security assessments** in simulated enterprise environments.
 - Delivered **enterprise IT leadership and cybersecurity oversight** for 500+ users across 10+ sites over two decades.
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Certifications

Certification	Provider	Year	Note
Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)	Offensive Security	2025	

Certification	Provider	Year	Note
Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS)	Hack The Box	2024	
Certified Web Exploitation Specialist (CWES)	Hack The Box	2023	
CompTIA PenTest+	CompTIA	2024	
CompTIA Security+	CompTIA	2023	
Mikrotik Certified Network Associate (MTCNA)	Mikrotik	2017	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>
Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)	Red Hat	2007	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>
Linux Professional Institute Certified (LPIC-1)	LPI	2007	<i>Expired, knowledge retained</i>

Technical Skills

Enterprise IT & Infrastructure

IT Architecture & Solution Design, Active Directory & Identity Management, Group Policy, Microsoft 365, Windows Server, Linux Administration, Virtualization (Hyper-V, XenServer), Containers (Docker), Backup & Recovery Systems, Email & Collaboration Platforms, Secure Remote Access, Infrastructure Hardening.

Networking & Secure Design

Enterprise Network Design, Routers & Switches, VLANs & Subnetting, Firewalls, Network Segmentation, TCP/IP, VPN Services, Secure Remote Connectivity, Network Troubleshooting, Resilient & Scalable Network Architectures.

Cybersecurity & Risk Management

Cybersecurity Architecture, Vulnerability Assessment, Patch Management, Endpoint Protection, RBAC and Least Privilege (PoLP), Security Awareness Training, Internal IT Audits, Compliance Audits (Microsoft, Autodesk), Policy & Procedure Development, Risk Identification & Reporting, Secure Configuration Management.

Offensive Security & Security Testing

Penetration Testing, Adversary Simulation, Active Directory Security Assessments, Enumeration, Privilege Escalation, Lateral Movement, Web Application Security Testing (SQLi, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, Command Injection, File Inclusion, SSTI, IDOR), Attack Path Analysis, Executive and Technical Security Reporting.

Leadership & Automation

IT Project Leadership, Multi-Site IT Operations, Vendor & Stakeholder Management, Technical Mentoring, Python, PowerShell, Bash Automation.

Professional Experience

Founder & Lead Consultant | Netrunnerz (Pty) Ltd – Gauteng, South Africa

Jun 2023 – Present

- Founded and lead **Netrunnerz (Pty) Ltd**, delivering enterprise IT, networking, and security consulting services.
- **Lead solution architecture, security assessments, and project delivery**, acting as a **single point of accountability** for clients.
- Work with **trusted specialist partners** where required to deliver projects at scale.
- Delivered paid VMware ESXi root-password recovery engagement for an enterprise client.
- Consulted on and implemented **GFI LanGuard** for **Microsoft patch management**, including deployment, configuration, and reporting.
- Provide licensing, deployment, and support services for **GFI LanGuard** and **GFI KerioControl**.
- Executed **50+ full-chain simulated penetration tests** on Hack The Box platforms (**SQLi, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, command injection, Kerberoasting, pivoting, lateral movement**).
- Publish professional client-style **penetration test reports** for every retired Hack The Box machine completed (**executive summary, technical findings with screenshots, PoC code, and high-level remediation guidance**).
- Ranked **Pro Hacker (Top 1%)** on Hack The Box and **Top 1%** on HTB Academy.

Group IT Administrator / Senior IT Lead | ACTOM (Pty) Ltd – Gauteng, South Africa

Leading energy manufacturing and engineering group with 500+ employees across 10+ sites.

Nov 1997 – Apr 2023

Delivered group-wide IT services and cybersecurity leadership for a leading energy manufacturing and engineering group with 500+ employees across 10+ sites.

Leadership & IT Service Delivery

- **Led enterprise IT operations** across multiple sites, supporting business-critical manufacturing and engineering systems.
- **Mentored IT staff** and provided escalation support and technical leadership.
- Delivered **cybersecurity awareness training**, including phishing and social engineering risk education.

Infrastructure & Systems Administration

- Administered **Active Directory and Group Policy**, enforcing RBAC and least-privilege (PoLP) access models.
- Managed **Microsoft 365, HCL Domino, Windows Server, and Linux environments**.

- Administered **endpoint protection, patch management, backups, VPN services, and network segmentation.**

Cybersecurity, Risk & Governance

- Implemented **network segmentation** using VLANs and subnetting to reduce attack surface and lateral movement.
- Managed **firewalls and VPN infrastructure** securing perimeter and remote access.
- Conducted **internal vulnerability assessments** and security hardening initiatives.
- Performed **bi-annual internal IT audits** and reported findings and **remediation plans** to senior management.
- Liaised with vendors including **Microsoft and Autodesk** during compliance audits.
- Co-developed internal **IT policies, procedures, and audit frameworks.**

Project Leadership

- Designed and delivered **server room infrastructure and multi-site IT deployments.**
- Led **ISP migrations, endpoint protection replacement projects, and Domino to Microsoft 365 migration initiatives.**
- **Coordinated vendors and stakeholders** to deliver **projects on time and with minimal operational disruption.**

Automation

- Developed automation solutions using **Python, PowerShell, and Bash** to streamline IT operations and reduce manual workload.

Finance Clerk | Reumech / Reutech Head Office – Gauteng, South Africa

Defence manufacturer, part of a holding company, before restructuring.

1997

- Prepared daily cash flow reports and payment reconciliations.

Education

Bachelor of Commerce in Business Informatics (Cum Laude) | University of South Africa

2018 – 2021

- Graduated with **25 distinctions.**
- Coursework included Databases, Networks, Programming, Project Management, and Internal Auditing.

References

Available upon request.